with one another as they please. The allowance to each is six stivers a day paid by their creditors: on default of payment they are released.

This prison being in a close part of the city, is one of the most unhealthy. But, I was informed, it is to be removed to a more airy situation in the southern suburbs.

The spin- or rasp-house has an inscription over the door, Stockholms Stad Spin och Rasp hus, An. 1750. It stands on a declivity, at the extremity of the suburbs, and near a lake. The number of prisoners was a hundred and eighty; twenty or twenty-five of whom I saw in a room, sorting, carding, or spinning wool: every prisoner is obliged to spin two pounds and a half (equal to about three thousand ells) of yarn in a day: all that is done by any prisoners more than this, they are paid for, at the rate of two stivers a pound; and, as a further reward, they become entitled to an abridgment of their term of confinement, in proportion to their diligence.

The women's apartments were clean; but the countenances of the men and boys were sickly, and their rooms dirty and offensive. The men were not separated from the boys as they should have been, nor the women from the girls.

The rooms employed as an infirmary were clean, and strewed with the young shoots of the spruce fir: it had in it five sick women, and five or six convalescents.

On inquiry, I found the scurvy was a prevailing disorder here, especially in August; which, I doubt not, is owing to close confinement, to the want of cleanliness, and to the use of salt-fish and other salt provisions. Some precautions are used against this disorder, for the prisoners at their admission are examined by the surgeons; after which they are required to bathe themselves, and to continue this as a practice twice a a month.

They attend prayers in the hall of the spin-house every day; in summer, at six in the morning and seven in the evening; and in winter, at eight and four.

A person in the office of an inspector has a convenient house here, with a salary of £50 per annum, which is large for this country, and four times more than the salary of the keeper. I am persuaded of the impropriety of trusting such establishments to the care of interested men. Neither the condition of the wards, nor the appearance of the prisoners, did this inspector any credit.

RUSSIA

In Russia the peasants and servants are bondmen or slaves, and their lords (or masters) may inflict on them any corporal punishment, or banish them to Siberia, on giving notice of their offence to the police. But they are not permitted to put them to death. Should they, however, die by the severity of their punishment, the penalty of the law is easily evaded. Instances notwithstanding, of great attachment of peasants to their lords, in consequence of good treatment, are not uncommon. A gentleman was shown me at Petersburg, whose peasants, hearing of his intention to sell his estate, brought him all the money they had saved, and gave it him, upon condition that he should keep his land, and still continue to be their master.

Debtors in this country are often employed as slaves by government, and allowed twelve roubles[1] yearly wages, which goes towards discharging the debt.[2] In some cases of private debts, if any person will give sufficient security to pay twelve roubles a year as long as the slave lives, or till the debt is paid off; as also to produce the slave when he is demanded; such person may take him out of confinement: but if he fails to produce him when demanded, is liable to pay the whole debt immediately.

There are no regular gaolers appointed in Russia, but all the prisons are guarded by the military. Little or no attention is paid to the reformation of prisoners. In the instructions for a new code of laws by the present Empress,[3] however, a very just and humane distinction is made between prisoners of different classes. "One ought not to confine in the same place, (1) an accused person, against whom there are only appearances, (2) a convict, (3) a criminal who is condemned to prison as a punishment. The accused person is only detained; the two others are imprisoned: but with respect to the former of them, the prison is only a part of punishment; with respect to the latter, it is the punishment itself."

There is no capital punishment for any crime but treason:

[1] One hundred copecks is a rouble, and a rouble about four shillings.

[2] An impracticable scheme has been advanced by a late author to oblige debtors in England to work off their debts by their own labour. The Marquis Beccaria, in his former editions of his *Essay on Crimes and Punishments*, had proposed some such scheme; but in the third edition he acknowledged his mistake, and confessed that he had injured the rights of humanity and was ashamed that he had adopted so inconsiderate an opinion.

[3] Catherine the Great.—[Ed.]